

Spanish Learning Cheat Sheet

Study smarter, not longer.

Simple, evidence-based habits that will help you learn Spanish faster.



Vocabulary

- ✓ Learn phrases, not individual words.
- ✓ Review your flashcards 5–10 minutes every day.
- ✓ Create your own example sentences.

- ✗ Don't memorize long vocabulary lists.



Listening

- ✓ Listen to Spanish every day, even for just a few minutes.
- ✓ Listen to the same audio more than once.
- ✓ Choose content you can mostly understand, but that still has something new to learn.

- ✗ Don't stop every time you hear an unfamiliar word.



Speaking

- ✓ Use the new words you learned this week.
- ✓ Speak from day one.
- ✓ Focus on communicating, not being perfect.

- ✗ Don't translate every sentence in your head.



Grammar

- ✓ Learn one structure at a time.
- ✓ Use it repeatedly in real sentences.
- ✓ Notice how native speakers use it.

- ✗ Don't spend hours reading grammar rules without using them.



Writing

- ✓ Write a little every week.
- ✓ Reuse grammar and vocabulary from recent lessons.
- ✓ Learn from your corrections.

- ✗ Don't ignore your mistakes—review them.



Get More From Your Lessons

Before class

- ✓ Review your notes and vocabulary for 5 minutes.
- ✓ Prepare one or two questions.

After class

- ✓ Use today's new vocabulary within the next 24 hours.
- ✓ Review your notes while the lesson is still fresh.



How Much Time Do You Have?

10 minutes

- 5 min flashcards
- 5 min listening

30 minutes

- 10 min flashcards
- 10 min listening
- 10 min reading

1 hour

- 15 min flashcards
- 15 min listening
- 15 min reading
- 15 min speaking or writing



Common Mistakes

- ✗ Studying only once a week.
- ✗ Waiting until you “feel ready” to speak.
- ✗ Trying to understand every single word.
- ✗ Memorizing vocabulary without context.
- ✗ Giving up after making mistakes.

Golden Rule

Consistency beats intensity.

Twenty minutes every day is better than three hours once a week.